One of the common misconceptions when starting a migration to the cloud is that you have to adopt a microservices architecture, build containers, and deploy them to Kubernetes. That is not true. Fremantle's post in 2010 is proof of that. He didn't mention any of those because they didn't exist. Yet, the applications he described not only are still considered cloud native, but they also comply with the definition given by the CNCF eight years later.

1.2 The cloud and the cloud computing model

Before focusing on the main characters, the cloud native applications, I'd like to set the scene by describing the context in which cloud native applications run: the *cloud* (figure 1.2). In this section, I'll define the cloud and its main characteristics. After all, if cloud native applications are designed to work well in a cloud environment, we should know what kind of environment that is.